

"You used to be a stripper, right?"

Road Trip and my writing process #1



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"What, you used to be a stripper?" I can hear him getting excited over me. Guys are so predictable.

The Road Trip keeps chugging along. A story about a couple who hook up at a bondage party and decide to take a road trip down to the tip of the Baja as a Gulliver's Travels meets Coming of Age meets Red Pill allegory. A spiritual successor to the Dog Walker, which is a hero's journey for a sexlife and sabotage. Colleen Hoover ain't got shit on me.

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In every book I try to hone more skills in writing that I didn't have before. It's better from a business perspective to get a niche and stick to it: giving readers a consistent set of expectations, like McDonalds,

but for fine literature. I've made a decent living and solid career so far by not being bound by my own successes, as small as they are in the grand scheme of things. Why change that now?

The first, and most important rule I have learned is the triangle of storytelling. Dialogue, Actions, Exposition. They are the logos, pathos and ethos of writing things down in my opinion. All dialogue gives you a movie script. All action gives you a fanfiction schlock, and all exposition gives you an essay written from a soapbox at the top of the mont. In the same way logos is the least persuasive version of rhetoric, I find exposition to be the lease persuasive form of writing.

Someone said *show, don't tell*. And from the little bit of reading I do, I agree. There's some writers who write some pretty good prose. Just reading the exposition is enjoyment in and of itself.

TheLastPsychitrist/Edward Teach is my goto example of that. Having said that, when I read *Sadly, Porn ...* The one part that stuck with me is the chapter of cuck porn he stuck in the beginning to make a point about how we don't control our sexual proclivities as much as we think we do.

I didn't realize he had switched to action and dialogue until I was literally balls deep in the fiancée justifying her affair, mid pump. I've been there before as the guy doing the pumping, and it resonated with my experience. I wrote about it in the Rose chapter of *Dog Walker*, but Teach whooped my ass with his prose. I can admit when I'm beat. I don't remember much about his breakdowns of Greek tragedy and other exposition laden chapters.

Frankly, it was hot, and that made me angry. It was a great way to show me what he was talking about that worked a hell of a lot better than 80% of the rest of the book that was telling me.

And I've used that idea to influence this new book

So in a book about driving in a car, there's not a lot of opportunity for actions. Some small facial gestures, sure. Symbols, like a Limp Bizkit CD, the AC in the car, a sun baked hood etc. Dialogue is doing the heavy lifting. Which is a fun challenge, and I think it will be rewarding to the reader. I'm betting on it anyways.

The premise is simple enough: a man who is selfless in relationships but jealous (read: man raised as defective woman) and the girl is selfish in relationships but not jealous (read: woman raised to be the man she wanted to marry) and so each conversation needs to reflect that. As the story progresses, their conversations and interactions need to show the change into man and woman proper. Where they are and what they are doing is a hamburger bun: the vessel that delivers the meat.

So as an end reader, I expect you'll get your cuck porn chapter experience, if I've done my job properly. My job in this case is having an editor that's better than me at making sure the vision and the execution have as small a gap as possible. Here's a small excerpt from the first chapters, the gimmick being both characters having the same story in parallel. This is the girls perspective.

(I have placeholder names of Rex and Kate for now. I don't have good names chosen yet, but it's not the same people from Dog Walker)

Road Trip: 3AM, WYD?

It's like we have always been soulmates.

"Wait. Where are you?"

"Vancouver, on the Quay."

"And you're on a date?"

"No. I left. The guy was an asshole, tried to pay me to date him. He's a rich kid. Remember that band that did that song, Working for the Weekend, Bah, bah... Something like that."

"BTO?"

"I don't know. But it's his kid."

Rex wouldn't even buy me a drink. He barely remembers my birthday, says he's sailing half the time and just disappears for weeks. I bought him a nice set of Whiskey glasses, and I think one time, he bought me some Skittles for my birthday. I don't even like Skittles.

"Sucks, babe. Hey. You're gonna love this then."

"Love what?"

"I'm in Vancouver also."

"Wait, you're here in town?"

"Yeah. We are here for the weekend. My friend is taking me to some party in East Hastings, you're not far then if you're on the quay. Come on down. I just ditched my date."

"You had a a date?"

"Long story. Some chick I met at Matt's bachelor party. Anyways, she was doing a lot of coke and wanted me to score her some pills. Last thing I need is to get a court martial for some stripper so I left."

"Look at you, a stripper."

"Yeah. I thought it would be cooler before. It's more a pain in the ass than anything."

"I could have told you that." Man. I knew he would have been hot enough to date a stripper. They are just do thin. Sometimes I wonder what he even sees in me. Least he's not paying for it.

"What, you used to be a stripper?" Tee hee. I can hear him getting excited over me. Guys are so predictable.

"No, you dumbass."

"Well, you got the look for one."

"I do not."

"Sure you do. Long hair, giant tits, nice legs. All you need is a coke habit and you're set."

"Oh stop." I bet he can hear me smiling through the phone. Ever since he did that cube thing he's always been able to read my mind.

"Seriously, come down. We are leaving in an hour."

And so I salvaged the worst weekend of my life by being invited to a party in ... East Hastings?

As I pulled up to the dockyard, I saw Rex standing on a bollard by his ship. He looked dapper. His hair was always short and clean. I love him in that white dress shirt with jeans. I hop out of my Honda Civic and look great. I wore this same skort on our first date. He even got the Tomato sauce out of it when I dropped it in my dinner. That other guy must have been his friend.

"So hey. Are you sure you wanna go to East Hastings?"

"Why, what's the matter?"

"It's like, the most dangerous part of the city."

"Oh whatever. Just stick around, I'll handle it."

I parked the car and held onto him while we started walking past the junkies and the homeless. I couldn't help but look. Each one of them could have a knife, or a gun or something. Rex didn't seem to care. He didn't even turn his head. He and his friend were just talking about the stuff they were doing at work.

"So what kind of party is this?" I asked his friend.

"Bondage party." It was hard to make out with his thick French accent.

"A what? Cool."

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